

Salvation From Adam to Moses

Since we have been studying salvation under every dispensation on the Born-Again Trail, what has interested me lately by the Spirit of God is the time before the flood, from Adam to Noah. When Paul taught redemption, he identified the time "where there is no law" as the period from Adam to Moses.

We are looking at that period to see the grace of God in operation before the flood. Romans 3 says Paul had already proved both Jew and Gentile under sin. That proof is in Romans 1 and 2.

Romans 1 deals with the early world, man's fall, and the operation of the death nature. Romans 2 begins to declare both Jew and Gentile under sin so God might have mercy on all.

I wanted to understand salvation under every dispensation because God is self-governed by His attributes. One of those is sovereignty. He sovereignly loves. He sovereignly judges. He is sovereignly immutable. When Israel came out from under the law and would not keep it, the whole world was in danger because the seed had to be protected. God would send another nation to judge Israel until they repented and came back under the shadow, so He could continue working toward the Seed, Jesus Christ, and the salvation of the world.

Understanding that gives me confidence in my Father. He did everything He could do under every dispensation for every man to be saved.

The price was paid at the cross, but those before the cross did not all go to hell waiting for it. They had accounted righteousness. In one form or another, they waited for the Firstborn from the dead to be born.

If Jesus is called the Firstborn from the dead, that must be speaking of spiritual death, because there were physical resurrections before Him. Adam himself was not raised from spiritual death. No one was quickened out of spiritual death until Christ, the Firstborn of the Church, was raised.

Those before Him either adhered to the simple gospel God gave in their day or they did not. One thing is sure: there was always a voice in the land, just as there is a voice now.

It is almost pathetic to go into a third-world country and see houses made of cardboard with sewage in front, yet every third or fourth house has a television antenna.

The devil has used television and satellites to spread wealth, lust, and sin. He jumped on those inventions, while the servants of righteousness have often failed to sell out with the same intensity to use them for the gospel.

All the treasures of wisdom and knowledge are in Christ, the Creator, and you are a partaker of His divine nature. The potential is in you. God is looking for people who will tear themselves away from themselves and become entrepreneurs of righteousness.

David Wilkerson prophesied that in the end time filthy material would be piped into houses and even clergy would have access to it and watch it late into the night. I have counseled enough preachers that you would not want the statistics. The battle is heating up.

But when you were born again, He freed you. You have a divine nature inside you. You do not have to yield to that.

God has a book of works and a book with names in it. After He shows the sinner his works, if the name is not found in the Book of Life, that person is sent to the lake of fire with Satan, his angels, and the false prophet.

One thing is certain: everyone will have a day in court. Death and hell will give up the dead so every person can stand before God, and He can show why His judgment is just and justified.

He will show each person the hour of visitation and the simple form of salvation they could have believed. In Adam's day, the issue was whether they followed Seth's line or Cain's. When Cain's line evangelized Seth's line into corruption and all flesh went his way, God in mercy reduced the whole earth to one family.

When the earth was reduced to one family, the knowledge of God filled the earth again. They sacrificed. They shed blood. God was not without witness.

Paul understood the law because he was born under that dispensation. He had been a Pharisee of Pharisees and had believers killed, thinking they opposed the living God. But when Stephen died in intercession, God had what He needed to save Paul.

Paul later said God did not bestow His grace on him in vain. He labored more abundantly than all. At the end, Paul the aged had one final offering left: his body. He fought a good fight, kept the faith, and finished his course.

Do not tell me you cannot stand up against low-level filth, procrastination, indifference, and complacency. Paul received no more in his new nature to serve God with than you did.

Through Paul, God explained spiritual death, the two Adams, the law, and the rebirth in a way that gives more faith than we know how to administer.

Romans 2:11-13 says:

"For there is no respect of persons with God.
For as many as have sinned without law
shall also perish without law:
and as many as have sinned in the law
shall be judged by the law;
for not the hearers of the law are just before God,
but the doers of the law shall be justified."

God is no respecter of persons. He does not respect Gentile over Jew, Jew over Gentile, Adam over us, or us over Adam. His willingness to save is the same.

Paul's point is that the hearer of the law is not justified, but the doer. Yet the Jew could not do the law because he did not have the nature to keep the Ten Commandments. That is why animals had to be killed. The blood of animals could not cleanse them from the consciousness of sin; it could only allow God to operate among them by accounted righteousness.

The man finally saved is the man who can keep that righteousness by a new nature.

Romans 2:14-15 says:

"For when the Gentiles,
which have not the law,
do by nature the things contained in the law,
these, having not the law,
are a law unto themselves:
which shew the work of the law
written in their hearts,
their conscience also bearing witness,
and their thoughts the mean while
accusing or else excusing one another."

The Gentile had no commandment saying, "Thou shalt not," but when he is born again, the new nature becomes a law within him. His conscience preaches that truth continually.

He shows the work of the law by not doing what the law forbids. How can he refuse? Because he has a nature that has set him free.

Whatever my new nature accuses, I will not excuse. I have two systems: the flesh and the new nature. One accuses the other. God will judge the secrets of men's hearts by Jesus Christ according to Paul's gospel.

Anything condemned at the judgment seat should not surprise you. If it were a surprise, God's judgment would not be just. The best thing is to let the new nature judge it now.

Those who sinned in the law were judged by the law because the law said, "Do not do it," and they tried to stop but could not.

That is what Paul meant in Romans 7:

"The good that I would, I do not:
but the evil which I would not, that I do."

With his mind, he wanted to keep the commandment, but something rose up inside and he could not do it. It was no longer he, but sin dwelling in him.

Galatians says:

"Cursed is every one
that continueth not in all things
which are written in the book of the law
to do them."

Jesus was born under the law, under obligation to fulfill it. He was the first man in four thousand years born spiritually alive and qualified to keep it. He kept it, then stepped into the shoes of every Jew who could not and became the curse of the law to free them to receive the adoption of sons.

Romans 5:12-14 is one thought:

"Wherefore, as by one man sin entered into the world,
and death by sin;
and so death passed upon all men,
for that all have sinned:
for until the law sin was in the world:
but sin is not imputed when there is no law.
Nevertheless death reigned from Adam to Moses,
even over them that had not sinned
after the similitude of Adam's transgression."

Adam had a direct commandment: do not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. He had God's nature and did not have to eat. But he transgressed.

By one man's disobedience, sin entered the world, and spiritual death came by sin. Adam passed that spiritual death to the human race. We do not sin in order to become spiritually dead; we are born spiritually dead and sin because we are dead.

From Adam to Moses there was no law like the Ten Commandments saying, "Thou shalt not," yet spiritual death still reigned over those who had not transgressed like Adam. They inherited spiritual death from Adam and produced the fruit of it.

That does not mean God had no salvation plan for them.

Go back to Genesis 3. After the fall, God spoke to the serpent:

"And I will put enmity
between thee and the woman,
and between thy seed and her seed;
it shall bruise thy head,
and thou shalt bruise his heel."

This was the first promise of salvation. Some have built a "serpent seed" doctrine from this verse, teaching that Satan physically fathered a seed through Eve. I do not believe that.

The serpent's seed is the unregenerated nature in man. Jesus said to some:

"Ye are of your father the devil."

The seed of the woman is the promised One who would bruise the serpent's head. A bruise to the head is a death blow. Hebrews says Jesus destroyed him who had the power of death, that is, the devil. The devil's power of death was his dominion over spiritually dead men. Jesus delivered a death blow to that dominion so we could be born again and become God's seed.

That was the promise those early preachers proclaimed: a Seed is coming who will bruise the head of the one who caused our father to fall, and when He comes, we will be set free.

From Adam to Moses, they had no written law. Their message was simple: believe in the One to come.

That faith fulfilled the first commandments in seed form. If you had another god or worshiped a created thing, you no longer believed in the living God who promised the Seed. If you took His name in vain, you were cursing the God who promised salvation.

The Sabbath later became a type of the rest we enter in the new birth. You could not pick up a stick on the Sabbath because salvation is not by works, lest any man should boast.

Some teach that Genesis 6 means angels mingled with women and produced giants, and that Noah was "perfect in his generations" because his bloodline was genetically untainted. I do not believe that angels mingled with humans that way.

There were races of giants before the flood and after it, but I believe that relates to the potential in early human life and its genetics before the earth declined and human lifespan was reduced.

The issue in Genesis is not angelic genetics. Cain's bloodline went one way, and Seth's bloodline began to call upon the Lord. As the earth filled, those calling upon God looked over at Cain's line, saw that the daughters of men were fair, and intermarried. With that came idols, flesh, and the full unrestrained operation of the devil until all flesh went his way.

Noah was a preacher of righteousness who walked with God.

Genesis traces Cain's line for a time, then introduces Seth's line. From Seth, men began to call upon the Lord. Enos called on Him. Cainan called on Him. Mahalaleel called on Him. Jared called on Him. Enoch, Methuselah, Lamech, and Noah called on Him.

They were preachers of righteousness. Adam lived 930 years. Noah lived 950. There was only a small gap between Adam's death and Noah's birth because men lived so long. Enoch walked with God and was taken. Methuselah lived until the year of the flood. Noah preached while building the ark.

Was any period uncovered by witness? No. God had a plan for that day:

"A Seed is coming,
and He will bruise the head of spiritual death,
and we will live."

God was faithful to preach that gospel in every dispensation.

Isn't He a faithful God?